

there should have been a bountiful harvest, an important favourable influence may thus be exercised; but even as regards this, it has been evident for many years past that the harvest question in England is of comparatively diminishing importance, and there is every prospect that much of the land now under corn will return by degrees to its primitive state, and will pay better as pasture for fattening beasts.

As we spoke of the Bank of England becoming temporarily rich, by the accumulation of revenue early in the year, so it becomes, as a rule, poor in the autumn. People are getting more used to this ebb and flow in Threadneedle Street, and the trouble it caused when Mr. Lowe first begun experimenting is not now experienced to the same extent; but still it is one of the elements which is disadvantageous, and to be kept in view by the speculator as a regularly recurring adverse influence.

It is, of course, of the last importance to keep a watch over the foreign exchanges, as these are affected more or less at certain periods when the imports and exports of special kinds of produce and manufactures are active.

Other influences which occur with machine-like regularity will be referred to as occasion may require, and we now proceed to go more into detail.

We will take activity among buyers:—It is clear that active buying in any market arises from a strong demand from persons who desire to purchase for reasons known to themselves. A strong *bona fide* demand for securities means that the public is making money, as they do not enter the Stock markets as *bona fide* purchasers, unless they have surplus monies which they desire to invest and put by in the form of savings. Now, a speculator who is watching for an opportunity to buy should keep in view one set of circumstances as favourable to his operations in the same way that a seller should watch for an opposite combination of causes as favourable for speculative sales. A bull speculator should know that his great opportunity occurs after securities generally have been driven down in price by a severe commer-